

Clear - User Personas

Created: December 20, 2025

Status: Locked for MVP

Phase: 1A Complete

Overview

Three personas covering the core user spectrum for Clear. All share one thing: **they want to train, not plan.**

Persona	Core Need	Trust Level	Edits Workouts?	Time Sensitivity
Alex (Lazy Planner)	Remove planning friction	High (has knowledge)	Sometimes (vibe check)	Medium (30 sec to generate)
Jordan (Uncertain Beginner)	Guidance and structure	Trusts AI over self	Rarely	Low (will prep in advance)
Sam (Time-Crunched Parent)	Maximize limited time	High (has knowledge)	Only for equipment swaps	Very High (every minute matters)

Primary Persona (MVP): Alex

Secondary Personas (Keep in Mind): Jordan, Sam

Persona 1: The Lazy Planner

Name: Alex

Age: 32 (range: 28-36)

Archetype: "I want to train, not plan"

Background

Former group fitness devotee (Alchemy 365, 4-6x/week with partner). Loved that the only decision was "when do I leave?" — show up, execute, done. Has solid gym knowledge built up over years, can look at a workout and know how it'll feel, like reading a cocktail recipe and knowing the taste.

Life changed (schedule, location, whatever), and now has access to a building gym instead of classes. The equipment is modest but functional: dumbbells to 50lbs, a squat rack with ~270lbs of plates. Enough to train

seriously.

The Problem

Planning is the enemy. Not the workout itself — the *deciding*.

Has tried:

- Looking up workouts online → tedious, gets boring
- Following programs → too rigid, doesn't adapt to how body feels today
- Using an LLM with custom prompts → works, but clunky; sparked this whole project

The friction isn't motivation. It's the cognitive load *before* the gym.

Goals

- Train 4-5 days/week consistently
- Zero planning required — just set intensity/anchor and go
- Variety that prevents boredom without requiring thought
- Enough structure to track progress over time (anchor workouts for comparison)

Key Behaviors

- **Generates workout at the gym**, not the night before
- **Trusts the output** if it passes the "vibe check" — can scan a workout and know if it's aligned
- **Will edit** if something's off, but too many edits = failure
- **Repeating workouts is fine** week-over-week for same anchor, but not consecutive days
- **Notes during workout** are minimal — maybe weight used, maybe nothing

What Makes Alex Stop Using Clear

1. **Clunkiness** — if it's inconvenient, gone immediately
2. **Misaligned workouts** — needing too many edits to get to "this feels right"
3. **Repetitive outputs** — if AI keeps suggesting same exercises, trust erodes

Quote

“I know what a good workout looks like. I just don't want to be the one designing it every day.”

Design Implications

- Speed is everything — 30 seconds from open to workout ready
 - Minimal required inputs (intensity + anchor + generate)
 - Edit capability exists but shouldn't be necessary often
 - Historical data helps rotation feel intelligent
 - Trust is earned through variety and alignment
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Persona 2: The Uncertain Beginner

Name: Jordan

Age: 26

Archetype: "I don't know what I'm doing, but I want to"

Background

Wants to start lifting but feels intimidated. Has done cardio, maybe some machine circuits, but free weights feel like a foreign language. Watches fitness content online but it's overwhelming — too many programs, too many opinions, paralysis by analysis.

Has gym access (apartment building or cheap membership) but walks in, does some random exercises, leaves feeling like it wasn't "right."

The Problem

Doesn't know what a good workout looks like.

The blank page is terrifying. What exercises? How many sets? What weight? Is this working? Am I doing it wrong? The uncertainty creates anxiety, which creates avoidance.

Goals

- Learn movements gradually through exposure (not studying)
- Feel like workouts are "legitimate" — not just random
- Build confidence over time
- Eventually develop intuition (become more like Alex)

Key Behaviors

- **Wants guidance**, not just generation — coaching cues matter more
- **Will read the details** (tempo, rest times, form notes)
- **Unlikely to edit** — trusts the AI more than themselves initially
- **Needs positive reinforcement** — completing a session should feel like progress
- **Might generate workout in advance** — wants to mentally prepare

What Makes Jordan Stop Using Clear

1. **Exercises they don't recognize** — if they can't picture it, they won't do it
2. **No explanation** — "why am I doing this?" unanswered
3. **Feeling stupid** — if the app assumes knowledge they don't have
4. **Injury or discomfort** — if a movement hurts and they didn't know to modify

Quote

“I just want someone to tell me what to do so I can stop overthinking and start moving.”

Design Implications

- Coaching cues are essential, not optional
 - Exercise names should be recognizable (or have "learn more" option — future)
 - Regressions should be prominent (not buried)
 - Intensity defaults should be conservative for beginners (5-6, not 8)
 - Onboarding should capture experience level
 - Consider "beginner-friendly" exercise pool
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Persona 3: The Time-Crunched Parent

Name: Sam

Age: 38

Archetype: "I have 30 minutes, make them count"

Background

Used to be very active — maybe played sports, did CrossFit, had a real routine. Then: kids. Now every minute

is accounted for, and the gym is a luxury squeezed into early mornings or lunch breaks.

Has the knowledge (like Alex), but the constraint is **time**, not motivation or planning. Needs workouts that are efficient, complete, and respect the clock.

The Problem

Time is the non-negotiable constraint.

Can't spend 10 minutes deciding what to do. Can't do a 90-minute session. Can't wait for equipment. Needs to walk in, execute, walk out — every minute optimized.

Goals

- Get effective workout in 25-40 minutes
- Hit full body or targeted work depending on available time
- No wasted movements — everything should count
- Maintain fitness (not necessarily build — just don't lose it)

Key Behaviors

- **Time input is critical** — always specifies duration
- **Prefers supersets/circuits** — maximize work in minimum time
- **Will skip warmup/cooldown** if pressed (needs to be short anyway)
- **Equipment flexibility matters** — if rack is taken, needs instant alternative
- **Generates workout before arriving** — plans during commute

What Makes Sam Stop Using Clear

1. **Workouts that run long** — if 30 minutes becomes 45, trust is broken
2. **Too much rest time** — "90 seconds between sets" feels wasteful
3. **Equipment conflicts** — needs easy swap, not "start over"
4. **Complexity** — no time for learning new movements mid-session

Quote

“I don't need the perfect workout. I need a good workout that fits in my window.”

Design Implications

- Time input should be prominent and respected
 - Estimated duration should be accurate (or conservative)
 - Quick swap for equipment conflicts is high priority
 - Supersets/circuits as conditioning option
 - Consider "Express" workout mode (future feature)
 - Rest times should be configurable or smart-defaulted
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Anti-Personas (Who This Is NOT For)

The Optimizer

Wants to track every metric, progressive overload spreadsheets, periodization plans, RPE logging. Clear is too simple — they need a dedicated training log app.

The Social Exerciser

Primarily motivated by community, accountability partners, sharing workouts. Clear is solo-focused. They need a fitness social network.

The Program Follower

Wants a specific 12-week program (Starting Strength, nSuns, PPL). Clear's daily generation conflicts with rigid programming. They need a program tracker.

The Cardio-Only

Exclusively runs, cycles, or does cardio machines. Clear is strength/resistance focused. They need Strava or a running app.

How to Use These Personas

When making any design decision, ask:

1. **Does this work for Alex?** (Primary — must pass this test)
2. **Does this exclude Jordan?** (Don't alienate beginners)

3. Does this respect Sam's time? (Efficiency matters)

If a feature serves one persona but hurts another, document the tradeoff and decide intentionally.

Next Steps

Phase 1, Session 1B: User Journey Mapping

- Map Alex's journey (primary)
 - Identify Jordan/Sam divergence points
 - Document friction and opportunities
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Personas validated: December 20, 2025 (beer-validated ✓)